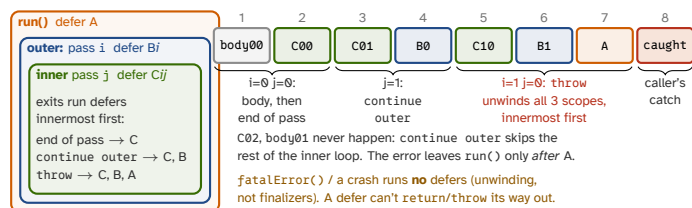


In one line: Every `{ }` is a **scope**, and every way out of it — `end`, `return`, `break`, `continue`, `throw` — runs that scope's defers **last-in first-out**, innermost scope first. A **label** names a loop/if/do/switch so one `break/continue` leaves several scopes at once; `guard` binds into the *enclosing* scope and must leave it; patterns (`case let x?`, `where`) turn loops and conditions into filters.

```
enum E: Error { case boom }
func run() throws {
    defer { print("A") } // fn scope
    outer: for i in 0..<2 {
        defer { print("B(i)") } // per outer pass
        for j in 0..<3 {
            defer { print("C(i)(j)") } // per inner pass
            if j == 1 { continue outer }
            if i == 1 { throw E.boom }
            print("body(i)(j)")
        }
    }
}
do { try run() } catch { print("caught") }
```

Nested defers through a labeled loop — what prints



Labels — leave several scopes at once

```
outer: for row in grid { for v in row where v < 0 { continue outer } }
loop: while true {
    switch next() {
        case .end: break loop // plain break would only leave the switch
        default: continue // continue always targets a loop
    }
}
parse: do { guard ok else { break parse }; step2() } // do/if: break only
```

guard — bind for the rest of the scope, or leave it

```
guard let user else { return } // user usable BELOW, not inside
guard case .loaded(let items) = state else { return }
guard !xs.isEmpty, let f = xs.first, f > 0 else { throw E.boom }
guard let self else { return } // in a [weak self] closure (5.7+)
```

else must exit: `return`, `throw`, `break`, `continue`, or a `Never` call (`fatalError`) — falling through does not compile.

Optional binding & loop filters

```
if let name { greet(name) } // 5.7 SE-0345: = if let name = name
if let a, let b, a < b { } // comma = &&, left to right, each binds
if case let .some(x) = opt, x > 0 { } // pattern + Bool in one condition list
if let n = value as? Int { } // cast and bind in one step
for case let x? in optionals { } // [Int?] -> only the non-nil, unwrapped
for case .failed(let m) in results { log(m) }
for i in 0..

```

defer details · do as a scope

```
func f() -> Int { var x = 1; defer { x = 99 }; return x } // returns 1
for url in urls { let h = open(url); defer { close(h) } } // EVERY iteration
func g() async { defer { await h.close() } } // 6.4 SE-0493: async fns only
do { let tmp = heavy(); use(tmp) } // plain do = a scope: tmp gone at }
```

Availability — runtime vs compile time

```
if #available(iOS 17, *) { new() } else { old() } // RUNTIME OS check
guard #available(iOS 17, *) else { return }
if #unavailable(iOS 17) { legacy() } // 5.6 SE-0290: `!#available` is invalid
#if os(iOS) // COMPILER time: code not built elsewhere
```

* = "every other platform, from its deployment target". Only `,` combines it with other conditions — no `||`, no `!`.

switch — tuples, where, fallthrough

```
switch (x, y) {
case (0, 0): origin()
case (let v, 0), (0, let v): onAxis(v) // alternatives bind the same names
case let (a, b) where a == b: diagonal() // where = guard AFTER binding
case (1...9, _): small(); fallthrough // run next body, NO match check
case (_, 10...): edge()
default: break // an empty body must say break
}
if case 200..<300 = status { } // = if 200..<300 ~= status
```

Errors — catch patterns, try forms, typed throws

```
do { try load() }
catch let e as URL.Error where e.code == .timedOut { retry() }
catch DecodeError.missing(let key) { report(key) }
catch { log(error) } // implicit `error`
let a = try? load() // T? - nil on error (T?? flattened since 5.0)
let b = try! load() // traps on error
func map<T>(_ f: (Element) throws -> T) rethrows -> [T] // throws iff f does
func parse() throws(ParseError) -> AST // 6.0 SE-0413
do throws(ParseError) { try parse() } catch { fix(error) } // error: ParseError
func pure() throws(Never) // = cannot throw; throws = throws(any Error)
let r = Result { try load() } // outcome as a value; try r.get() rethrows
```

Traps

- ! `break` in a `switch` inside a loop leaves the *switch* — label the loop.
- ! `defer` reads variables at *exit*, not at declaration; a trailing `defer` as the last statement just runs immediately (warning).
- ! `fallthrough` skips the next pattern check and can't enter a case that binds.
- ! `try?` erases *why*; `nil` from a `T?` function looks the same.
- ! `enumerated()` on a slice gives offsets, so `slice[i]` can crash — use `zip(slice.indices, slice)`.
- ! `guard let x` inside a closure binds in the *closure*; the `else` return leaves the closure, not the outer function.

Remember

"Exits run defers backwards, innermost first; a label picks the scope; guard must leave it."

Related: error-handling (model, Task errors, LocalizedError) · swift-enums-pattern-matching (8 pattern kinds) · swift-optionals · parameter-packs-and-new-syntax (if/switch expressions, await in defer) · swift-syntax-closures-calls · swift-attributes-directives (#if)